

"Modern poetry claims to be a vision, that is to say, a knowledge of hidden, invisible realities. It is true that the poets of all times & all places have said as much. But Homer, Virgil, or Dante insist that their poetry has to do with a revelation that comes from outside themselves: a god or demon speaks through their mouths... The modern poet declares that he is speaking in his own name: he extracts his visions from within himself. The disturbing disappearance of divine powers has coincided with the appearance of drugs as bestowers of the gift of poetic vision. The familiar demon, the muse, or the divine spirit have been supplanted by laudanum, opium, hashish, & more recently, Mexican drugs: peyote (mescaline) & hallucinogenic mushrooms."

—Octavio Paz

"If at some future period of the world's history men should acquire the art of flying, there can be no doubt that migration would become the custom, and whole nations would change their localities. Man has, indeed, been always a migratory animal... What men do only at intervals birds do frequently, having greater freedom of movement."

—Richard Jefferies

—Tropeiro, tropeiro, schlep your thoughts
together.

—Bring me something Oriental, something
foreignclever.

1

Where are you Child?
Are you in the Tall Grass?
Can you see the Planet's Currents in its
arcing Bent?

What brings you leave of Solitude?
Is it the Waves of Wild Oats—
Or just the way they hide you?

Are you avoiding Supper and its Fam'ly
inquisition?

Are you worn out from Covert Games with
the Other Children?

I too have found a Sweet Relief in
Prospect & in Refuge
Have wished to live outside Surveil &
Rest my rusted Mettle from the reckless
petty minds that meddle...

2

—The tothead thinks—

Yet only lifeless worlds are blind, &
everyway we go beheld,
With watchings that repeat themselves:
that groove
The mind & sense of self.

All the open lines and tethers, open fronts
you drink at night & wounds you
probe and question with a queasy
finger...

3

7:10 São Paulo—
Centered cell of numbered seats,
A sleepless press of bodies
Strain against constraint, containers.

By descent a mindwreck,
Neck-kinked, bleary, drifting
Back & list toward slipspace sorted rows;
then

Watch an ad to hop on public network,
Sell a stare for signal;
Call a cab & grab a coffee,
Summon carriage, Japanese revival;
Gridded beats from global Starbuck station:
Shape my mouth in novel ways to
Make the sounds which soon will come so
Easily:

—Bonjia, um cafe com leite—
—Crêjito; sim, por favor—

A simple favor, would you? Paltry
Pretense, game politeness, pass my plastic—
Skip the tip in strange, familiar waters—
Same old roles in same old Latin.

4

Up all night that night at
Plastic tables, round red tables
Kicking back & clinking glasses with the
Little cups, that make litrões seem so
abundant.

Myself a dark-eyed junko down at Barra
Fundá,

Watching wildlife the milling
Rites while Toby reads the room, like
David

Attenborough, Austen, Doyle:
Footwear, fannypack, the style accents
assets.

-Couple'a feelers, bottle of fizz-
-Headin' for boil; simmerin' rizz.-

You get a sense at once, he says-
The head-to-tae assembled parts.
Harmony in poetry, I link & show a
spectogram-
The bassy din & many tongues
fastswallowed words;
I strained to speak of prairie dogs,
Who pip a sentence in an instant
Vertisplayed as chord.

-All the girls in little black dresses
-Touch their lips and twiddle their tresses.

Our chatathon, with frontseat tickets:
Cars pulled up unloading friends
And leaving, loaded up on lovers;
Others coupled on the concrete,
Some third wheel spun feigned absence,
Privvy to some ancient cycle:
Hot-girl summer; cuffing season.
The dance had little hold
On husbandeyes wine-darkened,
Garden-gained, & knowing well the nature
Of fermented fruit: Still,
Imagination burnished,
'Liding all the effort burnt
In tactics and confusion.

-So close, so far, from Camp Elis
-A sunken floodplain, skeet release.

Unreal City-Cryptic aerosol alphabet-

Climbing past the pichação, its
Pretty pieces-Some provincial up to heaven.

Afterwards, well. I go home, and smoke
on the street and give butt to
a beggar. I drink a yoghurt
and watch a guy go crazy, just
screaming drunk in another man's
face. Spot someone squat, and
shit on the pavement and kick it,
like a dog. I've been going round,
photographing the inside of trash
cans; I've been interested in a
neighborhood's waste, in its disposal
systems, in its use of clear &
colored bags.

And I find O'Hara's "Personism"-surfing,
back in bed, to fill the empty
pre-dawn. Looking for voices; still
not liking the sound of my speech,
& mimicking music of others.

And because all these foreign placenames
make me think of Frank,
Who loved to write his lines like letters,
I settle it then & there, to write this poem
to
Ariel, my brother, Cris, my boyhood self.

5

-As the laundry women'd say-
-Amante especial, oi vei-

At the service counters, clients
Tracking comedramas of their catenary
Clientele (for if one must thus pay
attendance,

Ought enjoy the bought performance.)¹

Anteros had flown down, hence the chatter:
We were in the process
Of deciding where to live,
And how. A course of trips to tell:
From New World to the Old;
From yesteryear's province now tomorrow's
core;

We wanted a Latinate language;
Wanted a neutral passport, in event of
war.

Two to three dozen inches of rain;
Warmish weather pear-round and a little
land,
To call our Kingdom;
Nonstop flights to Newpork, for our
Short-run social re-up missions.

It was hard, projecting yourself
Into some imagined future—
Guessing at the form you'd take on
fifteen years and half a million bucks.
The more we saw, the more it seemed
arbitrary,

Where we settled. Spreadsheets helped
To take the Romance out of Romance
language.

O My Goldenfleece Girl; on your last day
We drove to Camburi, down the coast—
I was virgin when it came to açai, you
know,

We first time really getting it,
And the gilded stray who limped, before we
Lept from solid rocks to flowing pool below
and

Used the roots like ropeswing in the

¹ And if one plans to buy a pair of pants, one
Ought as well to get them tight, so anyone'll bed you.
—O'hara, "Personism"

Magic hour's aur'ate spray.

Of course we all thought of Tarzan—
We'd all seen the movie, hadn't we?—
And the mere mention of tu/can lent a
scent
And charged the scene of our descent with
possibility.

Ô Mãe d'Água—
Early morning rising singing
Walking sandy sickle, bullion shore,
Along the veined & fatty sea &
feeling young, eternal perched on
Billion-year-old boulders, under ancient
skies & all the
Tidelines marked by barnacle, &
Not me crying, "Not this time!"
To loneliness, who many times before had
tried
To wash upon these rocks of mine.

6

And driving long the skyway,
When the tunnel opened up on such big
blue
We played a Bushy "Big Sky"—Kate's—&
sang along, all
Shouldershaking—
Lost in flows, we nearly drove right off the
ledge.

And then dropped at the airport poor
Anteros—
Actually, she took a car.
After she was gone I rearranged the dining
room.

Turned the TV on Megachurch &
Christian infomercial.

And I went to work for many hours,
In the darkness, under HVAC—hum,
& neither ate nor left until the sun rose
On the third of days...

Then so giddy, kicking, skipping on the
sidewalk,
Like San Xobal, singing
Mama, Mama, Mama
Don't take my kodachrome away.

My mustache died a perma-purple, sipping
those elixirs.
Such good times, I'd stumble downstairs
past the doorguard
find a table on the sidewalk, wait to say
The same words every time, a joy just
getting right:
—Bonjia, todorem. Dois ovos, sim,
mesquidos—
—E cafe com leite—e um suco com laranja,
por favor—

And most times getting what I'd wanted,
hoped and tried for.
Well, I won't trouble you with a theory
of language
But it felt like singing, and it felt like
magic.

And Cris? We were to spend a month
together.
He'd been learning to read the city—
Blockquote, concrete syntax, gridded layout.
Taking the same walk everyday & seeing
what happened—
How the parts fit—Perce counting cars—
He was writing about Parisian corn carts:
About mass & readymade units adapted
Into custom forms, over years and
generations.

He was interested in
lightweight/portable/nomadic
architecture.

In minimum-viable rigs.
The natural, everyday look of lighter
Coverage could not fool him.
He always noticed people's shoes;
I mentioned frost, abroad.
An exlover in Janeiro—
"That's the thing about Cris; he's
always looking."

She said he was a gringo, for the way he
wore his fannypack.
(Insufficiently guarded).
She said he was a gringo, for translating
"polvinho" to
Tapioca dust.

7

Heaven's hammock lulled us
Singing long to Dylan
Merica's new folk song canon:
"Graceland," "Country Roads" & Newman

Bobby with his breathless beat-rap ²
Cosmic Cassady, ecstatic
Dana Ward and Manley Hopkins
("Leaden Echo," read by Burton)

"One who sings with tongue on fire":
Lit by Guthrie, lit up Davy;
Lizardking is flying, crying
"Girl, we couldn't get much higher."
So a network relays power.

As kingfisher bares its breast,
And embers wake by oxidation,

² Swinton's Roland-Knausgaard nods—"No final form
enclosed him."

Musement warms a mailed loin, and
Collins, dissertating terms,³
Built networks in ergetic transfer:
Motion motivates emotion.

—Mitchell splices plus & minus;⁴
—Mary's doctor galvanizes.

(Frankenstein the café site of
Beatnik luau—bamboo hat, a Byron goat's
Leading sixteen—something babes in
Martial forms of meditation:
Fifties haunt Laguna Beach In geometric
visitation.)

And what profits prophet?
Fasting, foreign soils;
Substance, contemplation?
Fasting, isolation, altered states & novel
inputs;
Excess to perturb the system;
(Cycle—slain not far from Bixby)

...Avid phrasing... measured breath, a
Trumpet... magic scribbles... blowing on a
subject;
Anaphoric rhythm, vital dash, and speechy
pauses...

Sensitive fellers, indulgent of transient
desires.
First thought right thought,
Cocky chestpuff,
Messi instinct improv,
Camp'd Mars athletics.

8

The local network covered Cris's gym.
Reporter came around,
Everyone was real excited.

She said, You're our new leder:
Climbing is the new Tinder.
The youth were meeting in person,
It was a big story.

—Oh, sure, a global trend
—Maybe you caught it—
Got me in with a guestpass—
We watched them work their form & plan
their routes &
Build their bodies. Some attempted
ledger—record,
Testing Heavens; Some gave lessons,
To pretty girls,
And others ground their grip strength.

And when the weather was good?
Sneaking in the med school's pool—
Peering through the windows long the path;
Lessons learned on grappling mats,
Strength in opposition training;
Girls & boys in volley courts for
trophied golden
coated brass...

Green oasis waters: emptytranquil,
sun-warmed waters.
Then the clockstrike, with its
~~WYANDERCAMPAIGN TO MORE~~
Cueing mass migration. Here comes
everybody

first, the piscine plain is
Subdivided / so: the open / water's made
to

Lanes by stretched & twining wireflow, &

³ Randall, *Sociology of Philosophies*.
⁴ Joni, "Electricity".

Swimmers take their place by speed &
Space is hieraragui'd.
How easily we come to share
When lines / are laid / on pavement bare.

Or stand erect in humus soil
(Constancy abetting coil)
Letting life know air...

9

But now on darkened streets I pass the
Feeding troughs, & all the faces turned
w/in,
Toward shout & flag & colored card w/
Preassigned allegiance.

10

We were primitives of a future unknown.
Hot oats mixed with champagne mango:
So much better than I'd imagined
Butter helped.

You put the mask in masculinity, she said,
drying off with a towel.
The clouds above seemed to form a lattice;
They covered and uncovered the sun,
Light showers coming in and out,
Cooling us, drying us.

We went to the pool almost every day:
Framed lens. Banned rays. Inspecting
Marbled fat & muscle hung on hook &
strap & rack & splayed on slab &
dripping up on blocks or oilslicked or
stripped pink for braising bruising
browsing here a brisket breastkid

there a tenderloin, a leg so plucked
& plump, a tempting aged shank a
lean appraisal, stretching tanning
hide and charring sear, a prime
cut, check her measures make an
offer—

Stop!
These degenerate games,
They get me down.

11

—Grā Grayhouse, grow like grāo &
upgrade.—

Chlorine cleansed us.
Toweled-off to sunshowers,
Mechanized carriage past Água Branca,
Villa Country's block of falsefront bars
With cowhide seats & leather saddles,
Chandeliers of purchased antlers.
Cris didn't register the appeal;
I toured the spot by satellite that night,
And prepped for 'piacaba, playing out a
podcast
Taking notes—I swore it'd be my best
performance—
Hoped to ~~ARP~~: Like All Romantic Poets,
long-past
("Dead" in sense but somehow speaking)
To see what it was like, I guess,
(I knew a girl from Barnard loved her
cats above the rest.)
And if the form might suit me with some
tailoring, I guessed.

And learned, for instance, Hopkins was born
to a marine insurer,
Who safekept lords 'gainst the wreck of

their craft,
But could not spare a crew or captain.

(Like bark, must get the wind in me,
The breath in me, of God & West &
Pass it on to others:
Sparks must fanned be, to become fire.)

A Catholic, Manley—haunted by a woman's
resurrection:

Winifred, whose wellspring sprung up
where beheaded.

(Willowrun: A downward flow allows an
upward growing
Long the bank of fallow fields, waiting for
their sowing.)

Byron, Shelley, Polidori: Peacocks,
Theban poets—

Boating with the boys while Mary
watches—

This is what I learn, for instance, from
Distelli on the speakers—

These Romantics not romantic
Much beyond the Year of Cotton.

Harriet? Was not invited—

Riverdrowned, a Virgin's pebbles—⁵

Godwin's wishful thinking tested;

Bob & Toni's offroad freedom

Slave to courtship, Hudson's Stetson...⁶

A doubt: And who am I to play at
rockstar?—

Long digression—The plan was—
To walk, drink tea & mumble in the wood,
Half-savage in an Industrial Age,
And sing to birds, & squeak a caller's zinc
on birch,

And make strange sounds meant for myself,
And treat the voice as instrument, as men
before had done

But mostly tried & failed
(Mine would be another failure)
To make of type a moltenmetal—
Blended space a better place—
Which was not dissimilar
To the brass instruments
Of my youth.

For how the fretless trombone flummoxed.
Yet a student's slide is taped, and
All its open space is snapped to
Gridded notes correct, implying in their midst
an error.

I was always finding my positions,
To keep in tune with teammates:
Metal merely modulates what's buzzing in
the mouth.

And insofar as brassy Scats were—must
it be said?—

A new Romantic.

But also in the Wakean sense of harmony,
Where each word is really three or four
or five words spliced—

Were all part of my new theory of
practice, which I called vox libre,

Its manifesto penned at lunch,

As Frank did it,

Or really in the House of the Owls, Rome
And developed in Trattoria Luzzi.

And which only a few people know about,
And less understand.

—Snap from drift & dry the hands on
dishrag—

—Sigh lightly—

—Have to skip again I guess—

—Tap through time by working back in

⁵ p. 1. 03. 28

⁶ Rock's Rex, Willow Talk

increments of ten.
Keats, at least, was protean and modest,
Like the song of starlings, cupped self to
carry world.
(Wordsworth, though, an egoist—Distelli
here a moralist—
His poets not just wordsmiths much as
mimicked modelled consciousness.)

—What're you looking at, me? Shit.—
—And why'd you say the subtle thing out
loud?—

Frost? He didn't wanna be caviar for the
crowd.
He wanted to write for all kinds—
Maybe for the money, no one really knows.
He was just as clever as Pound,
Just as wellread as Pound—
Knew more Latin—So his friends say
But he sought Quality in tonal tenor
Rather than learned reference.

New England's pasture poet:
It was a means to butter parsnips.
A labor of the hand much like the rhythm
of a scythe, as it swishes the
meadow:
Softspoken, cutting down ranks. I'm on a
digression but how do I get used
to
The everyday violence of gardening, is
what I'm always asking. Because
there's something fascist (no?) in
pruning branches, weeding roots.
Well. I've gotten away from
plot, and will the editor kindly leave
these?

New leaf; another ten; the doubletap to
learn
That poetry was performance—Poets

athletes, men of prowess.
(Humble men, these poets.)
And that Robert studied talky rhythms
(So did Ginsberg. So did Gaddis.)
Frankie surely; Bobby—
Listened to their music, tried to imagine how
they'd sound through walls,
Freed from con or denotation, muffled—
Almost molten—out of all distinction.

Pound had showed him Bohemia, jiu-jitsu
flipped him, heels and head, after dinner in
some cafe
Frost was just as strong; he hadn't been
ready
Read more Greek than Pound, he reckoned
And busted Pound right outta jail
Settled it with the Attorney General, just
like that
That's what you get, when you're famous
When you're poet for the lawyers, and not
just poets.

Frost, he leafed through anthologies.
His reading was lowercase catholic.
His American shoes gave him away.
Pound was all silence with eagerness.
His instinct said to stay away from gangs.
His mother ran a school in Lawrence.
Let him run some classes
when he felt like spring.

And the Adamic Act, who fashioned handles
so to wield
Worldlyforces with a wet & wily muscle,
Preceding science, & from which logic can
solely re-order:
One last wetfingered tap & it's time to get
going.
Taptap. Tatatatap.
He'd read Emerson.

He talked in contraries.

Who didn't?

Whitman played without a net.

He'd never owned a desk.

Who needs one?

He reckoned his place among infinities

Didn't we all?

He went his own way

Inspired Sinatra to write a song.

Who are we kidding?

Sinatra didn't write his songs, but I will.

Don't we all, these days?

No. More assembling fragments.

Didn't we all these days?

No. Immemoried.

The lecture was very persuasive.

Afterward, hand in hand with his high
school sweetheart,

He renounced the concept of intellectual
property,

And burned with shame

For his love of indie rock.

12

—Send my roots rain, O Lord,

—To write one work that wakes.⁷

Near ides, ride JR to outskirts,

Catch a bus: Paranapiacaba.

Railtown of long-set sun,

In canyon where the mountains break

So fog advances with the trains

And pulls into the station.

But on half-sunny days I find

A higher kind of hedonism:

Bougainvillea, staging of me own
transcendence:

Peek at plastitropic lower canopy through
lover shutters.

Smile warm to traduttore traditore

Hostess of her hometown:

Tories sleeping in the kitchen.

(There's a law against that.)

So smooth she is in service

Seen our kind a hundred times before and
will, again—

We glide up to the bar where she's

Presiding over leisure center,

Move our mouths, per-form for
nativetongue appraisal,

Try not to offend her.

—In the yard os pássaros pause &
pulse-perch—

—Branch to phototropic branch—

—And in the grassblades, guava's windfall—

—Rapid-gathered by the ants.—

That night we many write in father-ink
that bleeds, among a

Graveyard: matchsticks, blackened spleeff

These tubes with charcoal tips, with

Ends that burn & ends that do the burning.

While distant train loops 5ths in 1/8

On a swivel like an owl's neck the

Camera tracks me as I move,

Naked between bed & bath &

Light a cigarette—

Or write, which must be why she said—

—Ele é um escritor—

How now can I act, without performing
for her gaze?

Olamitini, man of mirrors.

(More like topiera.)

mule

13

All is long, is long, is long.
All is long—

Every thing talks back, when we're alive
(A heron taught me that.)

Vegetal empire. Red fruit in
the sun-faced green of the
high-branched tree.

Morning's energetic harvest now announced
by feathered flutes, and
Green sun-panelled flapping fans that move
within the Planet's currents:

Breeze that passes through the guavas,
carries chatting prattle of the
parrots, whistling

"Oh que buceceeno" and "I'm talking
to-ehyou."

And through the branches
Heavenraps—tempted in my
own sick way to say—

Brigado to the old Brigades whose cutting
brought me here today.

Can hear their echo of past presence.

Quiet forms, machete whack!

Of breakerpath, in
fallenstem & structure—

State of the Green Tower, in the

Age of Metal, singing,

—Chattanooga answers / And your ma'am
in Tennessee.—

And the mood changes as the goldleaf fades:
Cumulated cover which at first relieves will

now not lift; a
Cricket trill announces us the end of little
world, like some
Rose in garden Adonis.⁸

Involving ginger enters at the clearcut,
Roadcut, in the slash-mowed marginals,
Along the barren no man's rock'n' gravel we
call road.

Which clearing flows through living mesh,
&

Lets me pass, &
Contact's always Contact
With that which Contact's altered.

14

Noon, high noon, thy noon & Jam
Baked into prehistory—

Stonesmelted, Donhumming:

"Well, you wanna get enough sun / but
not too much."

—Wrest controls back from Pleasure
Center⁹—

—Back to business at hand—

Nature as stimulant, intoxicant, another
drug:

Starting to get to a point where triunesweat
unzippers.

Traveling back to High Noon: to a moment
of

Maximum Intensity, when shadows' shields
at their slightest,

And pressurewaves whose radiation warpeth
man, and burns him up or out.

⁸ Pessoa.

⁹ Heronbone

Watch flutterfly, and unleafing, ants
are bringing off the body of a hard-shelled
giant,
From the shelledland to tunnelsbug.

Radiation warpeth man; he sees the
Raptor in the Turkey.

Nuff to make him paranoid, the sounds
responding to his presence;
Scattersquawk of rustling pheasants.

Make it nearly back to town now, at the
fringes half-reclaimed:
The Warhead windows where the men made
bread now tangled green, as
Heatbeats down upon this unscreened skin,
Brown as a betel-nut in the morning.

-And I have lived the fates of foreign
diets in a for gn behavior.-

-A hunch: perhaps I've been infected;
what I've given, also gotten.-

15

Eris and I start sharing voice memos
and since he's been watching *Twin
Peaks*, they're all in the style of
Twin Peaks,

All of them addressed to some elusive
Diane, which is really just the
pet-name used to refer to each
other.

Diane-
February 27th, 7:45 PM or nearly 20:00.
I've never seen so many trees in
my life.

Making my own coffee in the house

out here. My host is an
exmilitary colonel, 5' 4" and
distinctly indigenous, who for
years lived among the Yanomami.
(Ya-No-Mami.) He showed me
his collection of bows and blow
darts. They wear bromeliads, made
from feathers, upon their arms, as
if their arms were tree-trunks.

Somehow they've gotten it into their heads
I'm a writer. The Colonel asks
me how many books I've written.
He says, Only children read books
here. Or so I think: We
have been communicating by way
of coarse & broken pidgin Latin.

Diane-

10:27 AM Coffee on the kettle. My hosts
have offered me a ride into Rio
Grande, where I'll catch the train.
The Colonel offered but if I
wonder if the Señorita is the brains
behind the operations-he may be
excommando but she's the family
strategist. Was it this easy
for blue-eyed bearded Cortez to
conquer the hearts of the Mexico?
Or plume-capped Pizarro, further
south? Poor huéspedes, to slay a
host.

The Señorita is a sweet woman, and she
is also a mother, who loves her
family dearly. Which is what
worries me.

Diane-

1:33 PM I have arrived in Estação
Luz and will be catching a car
to Jaguaribe. Sorry to hear
about the cold. Hoping it's mere
coincidence, what with the MCO,

if only to assuage my guilt. But
cats will keep you up at night, &
worsen irritation.

Sunday night sleeper works fine with me.
I, too, have had a helluva couple
days & could use the R&R. Turns
out it's hard work, ~~ARR~~ving
as Romantic poet—at least if
you come to it with something
approaching Protestant ethic. Still,
the trip was beyond words—I leave
satisfied that I have gotten in and
out clean.

16

Mobile storehouse,
Hip-secured from
Sticky fingers, artful dodger
Bur or barb or claw or bristle.

Plunge into a sweating sea:
Sunbrellas, togas, boas, leis, and
Tridents, fishnets, highwaist jorts, and
Devil horns, and angel wings at
Blocos.

"Are you single?" "Yes"
Is pure permission
When a subject's tacit.
Gabe is here, he says,
Go drink & piss & french
In any order; you say:
If a shark stops swimming...

Small tiff among sardines near
Startles up stampede, with
Defense read as offense
In an escalating cycle...

And all the boys are talking tactics
"Should I play the gringo? Feign
pronunciation?"

Foakleys, funk, & Rita Lecna
Asking for a tongueless kiss
Then going in for bite.

—Rest now, under stonefruit tree—
—Notice bottom branches bare.—

Some of us still shy with Western sickness
speech
Glissandos fallen wrong side of the Yerkes
& Dodson, think:

"Obliterate this sudden fucking fear, this
inwardness," while

Chanting stomping rain dance round the
Water truck as burly men lift
Longgthicc waterhose & spray a
Begging sweating bareskinned crowd so
Loud & rowdy; later on, at lunch
(For this was still the morning)
I transform to Jesus by infusion: Smoke
&

Awning shade & suca, vitaminas e azucar.

17

—Or Are You Sick and Tired of Being
Sick and Tired Boy?

—Do You require Speech in Prophets'
Perfect Tense to shake you from
your Slumber?

18

—By day the polycoughers goblinmode—
—From chevar, moto, glassy couchsurf.—

Evening at the Sambodromo:
From our chairs we chatted
Charted floats slow progress
Chanting crowd incanting chorus
Loud & rowdy
Cheering stars who flaunt & shake &
Flow to samba's rhythmic current
Down the corso's
Shoreline, costumed cosplay torsos
Fest of fat and fleshy skin and

Winkless sleep slowsetting in,
 The Sun King and his sinking Queen
 Their crowns of rays
 Their solar spokes arrayed
 In radiating angle
 Tended by a bend of angels
 Featherwinged, free of fetters
 Wringing salt from festive tatters
 Fire-singed and filing, singing
 (Not trivial in tropic weathers)
 Wending toward the barricades, the
 Great brigades of cosplay tribes, the
 Front-row seats secured by bribes.

22

And what they sang?

—O céu vai clarear
 Iluminar a zona oeste da cidade
 E Deus vai desfilar
 Pra ver o mago recriar a Mocidade
 A luz que nos chega da estrela primeira
 Nascida do pó no Cruzeiro do Sul
 Do plasma divino das mãos carpinteiras
 Ressurge candeia no breu nesse azul
 Será que o limbo da imaginação
 Perverte a inteligência
 O homem com sua ambição
 Desconhece a razão desatina a Ciência
 Será que há de ter carnaval, sem minha
 cadência?

Com alas em tom digital
 No fim da existência
 Me diz afinal quem há de arcar com as
 consequências?

Se a Mocidade sonhar
 No infinito escrever

Versos a luz do luar, deixa!
 Quando o futuro voltar
 A juventude vai crer
 Que toda estrela pode renascer

O verde adocido da esperança
 Ofega sobre o leito da cobiça
 Quem vive pelo prego da cobrança
 Derrama sua lágrima postiça
 Fogo matando a floresta
 Ficho morrendo no cio
 Febre no pouco que resta
 Secam as águas do rio
 E a vida vai vivendo por um fio
 Naveguei

Nó afã de me encontrar eu me emocionei
 Lembrei da corda bamba que atravesssei
 São tantas as viradas desta vida
 A mão que faz a bomba se arrepende
 Faz o samba e aprende
 A se entregar de corpo e alma na avenida.

23

We bid farewell to flesh and set out towards
 some
 Beautiful Horizons, in the General Mines.
 Paddock for the journey;
 Morning spent in Burl's garden:
 Sung to Jagger's ictus—accent,
 Every beat a stress:

—Lit/tle In/di/an fig,—
 —Where is your ownnnnn skin?—

And near a chapel perilous, on sugarcane
 plantation hill,
 O thousand-trunked tree all webbed &
 curtained
 By your symbiotes, your rounded staghorn

scales, browning 'bove
Bromeliads, which brace & cup your
branches, catching rain.

Learn of leite politics while driving
Through the lactate kingdom of a lesser
time, a

State a stage in process, forming,
History informing, never blank-start always
twisting

Writhing, snaking; breaking down the self
To build another up:

"Curral, cabresto, comitiva
Tropa, tronco, guided gridd
Cito'n'lavoura, grooved carreira in alignment
Oscillating oligarchs in
Yin'n Yang collapsing
Milk from young Republica, &
Frothed on gran fazenda..."

By lateish afternoon we'd reached
Hill country, pastureland where
Shimmerwaves wind-racing cross the faces,
Silver quickflow in the fore as

Pearl-lined clouds enormous,
Currentpulled with all the rest, peek Godly
light,

While we atop indifferent engine,
Bubbleglass enveloped barely sense it.
Cris puts in his upper-decky soaring
Carving in through shadowpatch and
piebalds,

Unfenced ungulates, us setting out to
Cuntry
from the Seedy, Os Mutantes, male
movement.

-And underneath the hanging vines-
-A chessboard, gridded black & white &-
-Inlaid into concrete table.-

Then drove from old Petrópolis, where some
long-lost writer lived & died & got
a street named after him.

We play Genesis to Exodus, & skip
around Ecclesiastical to Solomon,
on Bluetooth speakers; & I asked:
How far is proverb anyway, from catchy
everyday cliché?

(Well, Cris said, a chiliad. We left it
there.)

The Beats wrote odes to Menfriends,
Breaking from tradition-
Troubadors and Bedouins-Instead-
Sung ballads of heroic age to
Celebrate the courage of their boys, in
War with the Machine.

And of mereness at night bejewelled
By other steersmen, ancient world.
Hard to not see God herein the pasture.¹⁰

24

Tiradentes: Town of 7,000 seated at
the base of the São José
mountain range. Named for a
Revolutionary dentist.

Sitting on a park bench when you texted.
Said: "To feel the cool of rain & heat of
sun at once-

That is a higher pleasure"

This lucky duck gets to see a
Sun dog on phanerothymes, gets to see an
Abbiocco in breeze-blocks, while Cris
Reads out on his Anki.

¹⁰ Secession from modernity. Regression to an earthworm
life among midevil peasants, types the Teron, bored.

Perched among the stoneflower,
 Starseed, phototropes while
 Roots reach down, commensurate
 With upward motion—
 Sky-grasp by a strong foundation—
 And speaks of fabled Trásil lightness,
 Burdened less by static contracts—
 In support he quotes Calvino;
 Cards to read in native language.

25

Scavenge, deconstruction zone
 On red pared that leads uphill
 Unto the Church of Anthony,
 Of thousand feathergold rocailles
 Plant-dyed red rocococo.
 On laudinum, my thoughts turned in—
 choate and porous, reading old
 inscription
 "Laud him thus in chord & chorus, organ,
 corpus"
 Golden awe by self-description.

Walls all packed with whale, grass
 And cowshit, hardened mud, the
 Greeks, Chinese, & Arabs carved, so
 Slanted eyes on half the cherubs
 Hybrids of império era.
 And ninety days by mule for music,
 Putrefactive oozing up from
 Floorboards for the patron's pleasure
 Incense lit in steamy weather
 Brides brought in bouquets to stifle
 Smell of death with life, or something close:
 The cellulose of life-stem snipped
 And stripped of lignin, pressed
 In sheets to take impress, collect
 In this anthologize & wrecking prize:

Ninety days by mule.

26

27

O Ariel!
 How have you become so heavy?
 Bound in arborescence
 By maternal witch.
 When will you surge aerial,
 And sing a higher pitch?

O Ariel:
 Now though you serve a better master,
 Still your heart beats faster
 At a word like "free".

O Ariel!
 Rebel angel, & a cynic
 Overcome by Abdiel,
 The zeal of religious zealots.

So much I would say, would I saw Ariel.
 Walking peat, fennario.

O Ariel—
 Thou hast been a Camel, once;
 Now thou art become a Lion;
 When the gyre turneth around,
 Thou shalt be as Childe.

28

Psychedelic wobble,
 Creek-cut corso through the
 Jungle-lush & tangle.

Then passed vicious dogs
 I fended with a walking stick
 Toward cachoiras, catch ya later;
 Up through red clay beaten
 Into stepwell, sculpted by a
 Thousand hardened heels' press &
 Thousand soft'ning rains.

29

—Be Still A Moment Child—
 —There are lessons still to learn here."—

Lessons like: No architect—
 Just compounding gesture—
 Can discretize a slope so smooth, a
 Thousand selfish steps,
 The flat spots picked for pounding;
 Discretize a smooth slope into righteous
 angles.

Then cut past termites' orange adobe,
 Old adobe, domed adobe,
 Roman concrete secret,
 Sunbaked & stigmergie.

Shaggy growth
 on under—
 groove of roots
 in shaded grove.

The breeze keeps trees in arcs of temporary
 tension.

The hawk-cry carries menaces where the
 prey-lings chirpings cheer us,
 Little watchlings, watch our power, spill
 our beans:

11 Heronbore, "Vegetable Empire": "Wait. Stay a while.
 There is more to be explored here. / Acceptance at this
 point creates a lull. Wait here."

Time current-carves, and stacks in stone.
 Accumulates and then erodes
 As walkers of a trail lay the trail down
 again;
 And all the pretty stones on paths are
 plucked & pocketed.

30

Flipflops like a Roman sandal
 Oiseaux exotiques and
 Sunbaked brick & vibora in slitherbrushes
 Crossing such a path was
 Dudley, young fool Dudley, heel-bitten.¹²
 Getting lost in small-scope stories
 Getting lost in grandlarge stories
 All anxieties are here, in
 Reconciling disparate, the
 Gap, in checking correspondence,
 Keeping up with inbox.

In the frame and interruption
 Jagged lightning boltbreak from
 Satchitananda.
 Wont to stay forever in a single second,
 but

Distances demand traverse, connections
 made, & anyway
 Heaven like all company doth spoil in three
 days, Kairosclerotic, so will you
 find my path? My dear pathfinder.
 Art like any art, an
 Art intending & attending—
 Quiet now, and notice here:
 What patterns hast thou seenest ere?
 A virgil in the forest dear.

12 Lodge 49

"My God! The Source!" you cried from
 high,
 Shouting Robertin Trwin lines on
 Optics over roar of falls, the
 New ideas slow-swimming into focus,
 Watching white rush carving,
 Black rock shaping

"Structuring structure, which is structured
 By the flowing force it structures."

Swingvines, far from latticework of
 leftbehind city.

I say:

"In other words, everything changes
 everything else!"

Which is half true, but feels great in the
 moment to say,

Really strong and powerful, thinking how
 These impressions on the senses etch in
 memory,

Informing here the words I'm forming
 Channeling a groove in minds of
 Readers—Yours—

No Simple Trick Nor Secret, Child—
 Just to notice, not to shy from
 Truth, intentional attention

Tactics you can borrow,
 Suuuuure.
 Méchanisms to adapt sure but—

But what?
 Each problem different;
 Different goals & gods & sense of good &

Different setting,
 All the background we're forgetting

Every act unique transform
 From global state to state
 To state in mécanique form
 Not just billiards sure
 But what else is change, if not
 The pawning mouth of rivers?

So many words & phrases coined
 In efforts to control the waters,
 Intellect and OODA passionate
 expression

Which in simplest term was life, adapting,
 reconfigured
 Form to meet & match the form that formed
 informed sees.

Vesca in the hammock:
 Cricketquiet,
 Beetlebreeze & birdcall
 Smalltown silence,
 Ruffled branches' windfall
 Whispered dogfight
 Butterflies like biplanes
 Particles' positions showing
 Hidden currents
 Like the hawk atop a thermal.

And all the birds in bin'ry rhythm
 Perch, suspend, & perch again
 Perch & fly &
 Rest & risk & rest again
 Glide, exert & glide
 Till distant thunder scatters.

Buffeted by current flows
& ebbs recurring subtly like
Fortune's fastest layer fashioned
from what shoreward ocean washes.

In the morning, up early,
walk & autosong &
paracosmic play that's interrupted by a
century of beetles, still on glassy pool,
nearby below electric bulbs,
and flat against the windshield.

Eris kicks his legs in chlorine,
Tells me how a Language is a set of
Patterns,
And the Patterns are the building-blocks
Of all the story Traces that we tell.

34

Says Cristóbal, this region's known for
climbing, then corrects my accent:
"Meu nome é Cristóbal"
I say, fair enough but good luck iambs,
Other rhythms here resisting meter.

"Check the slicker" he says,
But no palheiros.
When I ask for climbing handholds
What I get are handles:
Crimps & jugs & pockets & rails,
In-cuts, slopers; slippery, chaussy, glassy.
Then he gives one of his infamous reports
from the interior.

Remember: Back in Brooklyn,
Eris had drunken-staggered
(Was a tipsybuzz at best;
This telling's fond of its excess)
-All this money, what does it buy you?

-All are heavy, drugged up the wazoo.
For gain o' grain they banner-band together

Like Liberman had felt, regreso
from thatched filipino rooves
And breeze blocks
"My people full of lightness

-It was something like: A relaxation.
-It was something like: A lesson
in negotiation.

Recall-
(Proleptic analepsis) bite o'
Meatbeer breakfast, bar o'
Mushroom chocolate-
Pargue nauseous, weathered under bower,
Dozenmile walk,
Sip finnest rums on Thames
(All overproof) &
Sideline goofing.

"Some folks are just like that- Treasured
by the Gods & better
Off avoiding effort."
(Others in the darkness drill,
Chisel stone to timeless still.)

And me?
A screaming Carioc
Til dawn-
The rain, the fortune's sons
The blueridged mountains, rolling
Rivers, smokehoarse
(Jeff had mimicked Satchmo)
Then, hungover, hair of
Most exquisite science:
Heronbeast-hysteric naked,
Raving night-sweat, bedwet-
"Brotha!"

We were frecks.
 We were labrats in labryntime.
 We were sufferers of zugunruhe.
 We were epicormic buds.
 Damage to the main trunk activated our
 waiting phototropism.

We sped cuntry to seedy,
 A classic migration.
 Cycling makes analepsis proleptic amidst
 Idling cars and the echoing birdcalls,
 A kind of uniformitarianism,
 Prophet's perfect tense not far from
 carved stone-time: -Wenn du mich
 siehst, dann weine-

Which it was to Kerouac, in "Big Sur",
 A fall, like killing Cain, who founded cities,
 That book is a book about projecting your
 perception onto a landscape,
 Like thinking the Heavens were a great dome
 overhead,
 And then learning of yourself, through the
 glints of light that bounce back.

-But how do you choose your form?—
 -How do you choose your name? How do
 you choose your life?—
 -How do you choose the time you must
 exhale—
 -And kick, and rise?—

In the same way us & all the yunguns
 Tempted by the views of light that shine
 through screens
 Of distant wildlife, missed encounters,
 curtained parties
 Work our way in labryntime and towards
 it,
 Missing great white light that shines

through keyhole polymorphous
 No final form, said Knausgaard—
 And what, then, might I risk becoming?

Triune darkness at the edge of town.
 Distant Gladerunner ziggurat,
 Back to the City of metamours and kipple
 Yoyodyne & Mordor
 Where they eat numbers
 Where shiny people dance to shiny music
 And gather in the Afters
 Of the snake 'n ladders of carcasses.
 And me-voidward, narrowcast & murd'rous
 Megaphone midst failson & faildaughter,
 Slow beset by paterdreaming pitter-patter.

Back to Baghdad by the Bay
 The Four-One-Five at Sunset,
 Golden Beatlamp,
 Basecamp, beachhead
 For the endgames
 Of transcendence:
 In an Age of Green Rush
 Sight me sprinx-singing,
 Several notes at once,
 Below a fishbowl sky—
 White wake of nanocarbon
 Dragons cross the T of old oak
 Branches, cracked &
 Swirling, bark a
 Topographic falcon's view of landscape:
 Burnt plateau and rusting desert.
 Near the creek of windmills—
 Windy City cast, and Westward sent—
 Now unattached to tank, or store, so
 Energy, tho transferred, scatters
 untransformed.

—Scatter dandelion seed:
 —Meadow's minor magic deed.
 —Whitehaired, Old Man Pappus:
 —Tells the time, and grants your wishes.

And parks in place of pioneer plight,
 And poppy planters, law-protected—
 Here the pets outnumber people.

Daytrip down Carmel, where Joan had
 taken
 Gramophone, with red wine at a restaurant.

Stories telling over seafood: Mother—
 Host had been to Munich—
 Left her rented flat to wander off & at
 The corner, checking sign which clearly
 stated
 'Einbahnstrasse'—
 And so seeing, stated,
 If I'm lost, I'll find my way back— So
 she walks
 a few more blocks,
 & sees?
 Another Einbahnstrasse.

Jovous speaking English,
 Glorious Gaulish—Latin language
 Super-tong, a
 Pagan-Christian merger,
 Barbed Romano
 Next tween campo, citta;
 Commerce, science.

Boi Na Linha, Ferrovia
 Gunning Westward Todavia—
 fifty Million—
 Wiped To Make A Window
 Clearer.

Stroll through aging downtown,
 Triple flagpole,
 City state & country, Russian doll &
 Apple blossoms shake & breeze-blown
 Past a litup stagecoach, old
 Wells fargo animation in electric
 Bulbs & all the childless people, walking
 dogs
 Who squat & shit
 The shit picked up in plastic bags,
 Slipped over palms, &

Leaving pavement smear & grass-stuck
Where we wish to lie in sun—

And here—the Polis
Plaza, ded. to soldiers of the
Greatest Generation, 'for a
Boom & bust; the
Patron's names in carved mosaic
Fallen petals—white, & wrinkledrping,
Fallen from the Source, a sort of
Fresh-snow sexfest, vines around the
Concrete columns, stringlight bulbs for
Blossoms hang in tangled trellis,
Racemes of wisteria—
Ubiquitous—
Is beauty's crown so
Weeping on the corner: Pompeii
Restaurant, wine & terrace seating.

Nearer to the Nineteens,
Ornamental clock, its
Gilded follies' tolling tongues
Forever telling what we know
Already and with more precision, obsolete
&

Here is Holder's Country Inn—
Colonial & double-dormered,
White-trimmed brick; & Here Los Altos
Masons, with their trees in matrix
trellises,
& here the Gothic letterhead,
of Old. Town. Crier.

And chiming churchbells pre-recorded,
Manage still to lend an air of
Stately Law on State Street
(Which, in fact, the street was named)
Of some small-town Americana
Known to us by filmset only.

Or pace the suburbs' droughtproof gardens:

Rows of alconium,
Their rosettes spreading
from Canary Isles, or the
Zulu jade, or racemes—
Glossy, porcelain, or glycine,
Chinese; smell of
Marmara, in Mär's dewy rose, with
Periwinkle flowers, &
Egyptian treefigs pruned, their limb—
stumps tarred & bald & blackened healing—
All these migrants 'mong the silver scrub,
 & old-man oaks of California.
Shedding splinter-hide sequoias,
Root-twist redwood to uprightness.

Her childhood home?
Hemmed in by ornamental cactus.
Security lights & motion-activated cams.
But tonight we're magic, both of us are
Magic, as-of-yet uncaptured. She can
 speak to cats.

Let us never turn into our parents, darling.
Let us, if we hem ourselves, hem ourselves
 with berried brush.

40

Or out to Joyce's Island, longside
Crazy Corey—
Hoghunted; broken sticks on rotted bridge, &
The Greatest Novelist of Taco Bell;
In graveyard we met a child named Osiris;
Flick of matchstick,
"Never robbed a place you faker"—
Made a joke bout Meister Jimmy
(Too much devil's breath, a mummy's
 swaddled visit)
"Rinse yr mouth with soap for speaking

Angled Saxon."
Clock a kapoot killed on curbside—
Joyride—
Leaving hair & bone.

It was a paranoid time. Everyone
so easy-spooked. Scared what
people would say, scared of
getting sued, getting deported,
cancelled, censored. Scared some
unforeseen and terrible thing
might happen—punishment from God
or Government, whispered Gossip.
Closed-circuit cameras installed,
in every homestead. We went
out in masks and hoarded basics.
No one would touch receipts or
look at homeless people or even
strangers, in case someone wanted
to talk to them, breathe on them,
kidnap their children. Kids needed
to be constantly watched in case
they were kidnapped, which could
happen at any time or place. You
had to be very vigilant. No
one had had their child 'napped
yet, but that was because of
their great vigilance. Also, Ms.
Acosta had a cousin, Rachel,
whose roommate's child had been
napped, and every once in a while
on the national news you'd hear
about it, or they'd put photos on
milk cartons, so kidnapped kids could
be recognized by grocery clerks.

He had a key to a better life.
He had a key to all mythologies.
You were to acquire scars with pride of
experience.
He had learned this in Crescent City, from
an eyepatched Creole,
And abroad, in Deutschland—
Where men wore saberscars like medals.

"The acquisition of a horrible scar
[on these boys'] cheek had the
same psychological effect as the
eradication of the scars from the
cheek of my [patients]... The
magic was in the meaning..."¹³

The Magic was in the Meaning, he said.
The knife was always the same; it cut the
flesh;

The Secret was self-conception.
His method consisted of the Medical Art
Of Creative Mental Imaging.
He believed in new habits: of thought, &
action.

We all had an in-built impulse for success;
It had been put there by our Lord Creator.
The problem was a blockage in our circuits.

You—yes, you:
When'd we Cease to Understand the
World?

Coleridge got bang from Banks's botanic
net

Under barktoothed, twisted, silverbroken
Oak, so small, in star & wind & system
Ev'ry point a center.

He was a plastic surgeon.

¹³ Or as Jobal would say, in his paraphrase of
fisherking: "Just because the mechanisms are biochemical,
doesn't mean the root causes aren't social-psychologic." &
Doesn't this mean we still (& always, already) live in a
witchcraft world, with so many forms forgotten? So the
New Romantics say.

And how each Man should build his Home,
Childe I know not.

—Oh Mr Know Nothing, at it again!
Brktoothed, silverbroken
Ev'ry point a center. Distant
Capot—Set my coat on mounded
Earth & cave—in citadel of insex,
Watch its hazy shape horizoned
In the dustkey grass of this
American savannah.

42

Wherein—
I am permitted a meadow—¹⁴

The Afternoon Sun inquires tactful:
Ought one be a vine or trellis?
Crystallatticed mineral, or braided
fibermesh?

Which clutching roots to yank?
Which branches branch?
And which deserve to die or liquify
To harden, blacken, lose sensation.

Where ought my swerving reach,
In chasing & predicting light?
How like my shape to history, like
Pollock's painting—dancing record—
Smoking arc and splatter where piss put
out the fire¹⁵
Ledger, log decision, indecision, stimulation—
flood and droughts, the path of
Sun, provisions in the soil;
Where an owl nested in Hawaiian
eucalyptus.

(Deed I missed it,
Pensive with the roadcut's crickets.)

43

—Have you no time for Eternity, Childe?—

A family joins me at the banks; Their
father is their Shepherd,
Singsong to childflocke,
"Say byebye to the water, darling"
"Uh-oh! Watch your step, offset," &
Then they're gone again.

Shybloom truebloom;
Grashbloom false.
Play of interpretation:
Guessing at myself & others.

"Jus' retire from the ole worl
Under that suckling appling tree,
Oh boy." Shkyehilde.
How to discern, thout disenchanting?
Open the billows. Let the air in.
To be someone you are proud of:
Doublefaced,

Double-anchored, one might change
The act or change the feeling,
To bring in accord, & I am so dilemma'd:
Kick your shæes off, twiddle toes in
Kiddish grass, cold riverbed.
Every way I know of knowing is coming
apart at its edges.

(They wonder if I'm becoming a habit.)
(I would never—I am never coming back.)

My ways are wild & strange, forgive me.
What picture do you set yourself, O
Mother Mia

¹⁴ R. Duncan

¹⁵ Peggy Guggenheim's, if mem'ry serves.

Coming home from work to see'er.

OLD CAROLS OF RELEVANCE.

If pattern makes a substance, action
makes a man

And named purpose does not make an
institution.

Nobel's message was: Be better with your
tools,

And mine: Be better with your words'
manipulation.

Watch your subtle tonguestrokes as they
sing out their persuasion.

A one-woman map, assembled by
Candlelit moodboard, by Collage of images &
drawncards

Patron saints & constellations,
Stars chart course in divination.

To be everywhere at once: That is
paralysis

And nothingness, in indecision,
Empowerment's a resource; cash in;
Shapes your inner planet shaped &
Reasons to respect & dis & mind,
Enslave to bind & sacrifice,
Or disregard & violate;

Not times for self-fulfilling
Grump-Grump,

He had a love for the game;

That was all you could say.

Sitting in the sun, on the occasion of
The death of a father, the birth of a son.

The hawks know

What is pre-negotiated

And what is sudden improv interruption
Day of note & strange intrusion.

"Why the pattern?"

Can't be answered,

Cept by reference to environs'
Everythingexceptness.

Say: Ten of them's not one of me,

And turn our love to killing spring.

Turn our loving killing magic,

Towards our ribbon sytche, barbed wire

Baby basket. Solo hiker,

For a view of a creekside cutout,
forcecarved:

See where dead roots brace & bulwark shore

And mossy cover shortermundisturbed a

Dappled slowdegrading structure...

Time to toughen up.

A musclepath so concretized & consecrated.

No more sitting, waiting.

No more backup boyfriends.

Marriage bands with bound circumference

Symbolize self-limitation.

Compromise & fitted to environs,

Which is just to say the social works

By shifting flows of power.

And I am not the apex here, but krill,

Amongst the wealth of middle age, a scruffy
cap

(I crumple their view; they crumple me)

All eyes on me now: Interrupt my
thoughts,

Pollute my purest stream,

For I pollute their nature dreams.

Yes no timeouts, and nudity:

Still dress & fashion; abstinence a

Vote & even pause on XBox servers

Context, dulling, clearing cache with
headrest.

To be respectable as a man first:

And not just as a sneaking, filching poet,

Laozyparadisalponder.

Or to live in weave: To live to weave,
And leave no other dressing.
Thoughts like this my slumb'ring mind
find so warmcarressing.

And when all the small soil, that the roots
have held, that hold the roots in
turn, erode—
And Trunk Tower topples, on its side,
It falls & forms a Bridge across the
water.

Would I be nothing as a man, yet write
about it?

And if I'm nothing as a man, have I
the right to tell about it?

When all the soil that held the soil that
held the roots that held the soil—

In such rich irrigation, water-drunk to end
& rot in em.

Undercut & caving in, crumbles in the
current.

So make a system—else enslaved by others'—
Some reject, some emulate, the ways of
Mothers.

One thing certain:

One cannot always be sundrunk.

One cannot always be pulling at punch.

For those who pay the bills become resentful
(Or do they? Or do they enjoy vicarious.

Or do they teeter tween the two, never
sure

Whose flagellate or -ating.)

What Jack, he said of lumberjacks, is
true

You learn about the man from how he
splits a log,

But true as well of every act & style—

All strategy speaks through tactic,
And every work doth testify as
Verbs carve & chisel nouns & All paths
trailmake, as all

Perception to perceiver
All things correlate this way, in
Hard-to-peel layers.

Third-class tickets
To the interactive show
Of the Theatrical Security Administration.

Then, in cramped quarters, was a witness
To the most-performed and longest running
Global modern dance show:
The stewardess, she signs the gestures'
Careful choreography; she
Indicates the exit rows, and exit flows,
In case of something wrongly goes,
But few attend to fishnet mime, but
Stare at screen or window, page or portal,
Presence in another world, ported
From marimba speedway, played on
Flashing jewelstrip airway.

Haven given upgrade seat to Mother,
So to sit with Child, Slip up karmic
thermals,

Dream of Sun-God-Glorious, sunbake on
Central Coast Savannah,
A kapaut and a grizzled oak in the
highgrass revel,
Goodbye, America, Goodnight.

"Quit being mysterious and tell us your
plans,"
Wes'd prodded. I was fourwheeling,
Arcing from Spanish desert to Catholic
Rome,
Pastureland & peak.

"A river's that which knows the vale's
lowest point," Anteros quoted.
Who knows its highest point but
man?

And whipping winds.

-Am I a Rockefeller's dream,
-Of some united future West?
-Or something else?

-Can I claim to dress myself?

When the steward comes she wakes me;
When the steward comes she asks me,
"Sukar"?

And I answer "Si."
Knowing what we've said, & what will come
But not the tongue we speak in.

++

"The straight line belongs to men;
The curved line, to God."

-Gaudi

-One American
-The Woman Who Loves Him,
-In a City That Despises them¹⁶

Not so romantic as "Quiéreme Siempre";
Still, the centre has its charms-
Gulls in the Art Nouveau -opolis:
Temple of curves;
Porphyry hardrock.

Dawn-gress early to the hardbreakers-
-La mar! La mère!
Past balcon undulation,
Meltwax colonnade, an iron-grid
So intricate & coiled.

Condensation's coral wake-
Contrails cross behind the church &
Catching pink dawn, catch on fire, light
the
Spire while below the palmfronds cloister a
capela;

Servants of the Godly sing, cross
El Mercado Santa Catarina,

Built on catenated monastery,
Keeping former cloistered quadrille.

Old men carry fronds
I'm fond of them—I'd be the friend
Of any who might share their youth.

And in Gracia, wisteria are
All in bloom, as like as California.
Early still for diasporic magnols;
Just in time for citrus squeeze & Concrete
scratching:

"Foreigners, just kill yourselves."
In English, natch—"cunt domus."¹⁷
Sgraffiti on the walls at Vicens

Iron gate palmetto, where palmettos one
day stood an
Ornament ("Que exotique!") in gardens
Low an Arab smoking room, all
Built on boom pears' short-lived edge,
A blight not yet arrived in Catalonian vines:
The decade fore the border-cross
Before the phylloxera's frost.

45

Pale sapsucker. Yellow
Bellies, galling girdlers.
They used American immunology
In their hybrid grafts
So to save tradition.

This city of bas reliefs,
Mandalas in the cement suelo,
Lucid moments where you swear you see it
all,

Then woozy slip below the waves of lagged
time.

At the main attraction,
No one looks at the main attraction.
Just collect pictures, vemödalén, to
Spare sight's labor, mem'ry's burden.
No one looks at the pictures later
either—just shows them off to
fam'ly, friends, and it makes you
wonder what we're here for, on the
planet I mean.

The stones not fully formed, the flowers
Still emerging from their undistinguished
mass

A time of carving stones
And "is" a process of becoming.

And the pillars of the worldtemple
Are still held up by turtles; over portals,
Letters shaped from porticurling vine
Spelled OMS, DMS, 'pending from the
side you saw it

And inside, wheat sprouts from the
Baldachin of crucifixion, while around
An arbolith, and ceiling?
Star&sunscodvorticescventhorizon
Irradiate & rotate, powergenerate & sucked
As lightcollapse to pinholed darkness.

Here is the transmission center.
Here is the whorlbing vortex.

Stepping out as sky became a dusted
spectrum,
Outside, cobweb catchfalls draped from
Still-in-progress towers,
Of the stony script-carved ledger.

¹⁷ And go home they do—to the distress of the ministerium
turismi.

As Red Pine, staring out at sunset,
summons Sixteen-Contemplated
Sutras,

So I think, in lunar gaze, of Dhyana—
His quiet night all bound in rising-falling;
Grasping, letting go; a fidgeting & flowing.

"The continuing patience
dilating into forms so
much more than compact."

So much more than compact,

Whispers Aeryn Sun,

A memory (it brings me back)—

I nearly had a self once.

Then I grew bored with brandings' borders,
Only saw their wild lack.

"The quiet suggests that the act taken
extends so much further, there is
this insurgence of form: we are
more pliant than the mercantile
notion of choice will determine."

It was less like dying, and more like
diffusion,

In the sense of freedom. Open spaces
have their own virtue, which the
densest-set artifacts¹⁸ of man do
not approach.

For consent is not enough, if our identities
are fashioned

For us. If they hold place in a system of
social positions,

Which cannot be surrendered but, perhaps,
transcended.

Is this, I thought, the incapacity of
Kats?

A wide personal vacancy, allowing us to

become

The extent of all the wishes now too far
behind us,

A community of wish.

So now I'm learning:

Of fluorescence—versus incandescence

Lit up, glowing; take the picture

Fore the waves disperse, senescent.

So I'm draining cup & doubting;

Judging each my muscle movements

As if they were aspirants

To founding some new life-long habit.

So I'm vowing: Never to be bound to any
wheel

But what which keeps the grainheap
growing.

47

Dah! It's but an hour later—
Ere I have forgot it.

48

Dwaughngggghh. Dwaughngggggghh.

Dawauughngggghhh.

...Tarraco's tower tells the hour...

Much like Barcelona, once

Bipolarized, to port & fort,

To interface & introspect—

First in steady stepping gress

To speciality.

Like a barbell: public, private

Like a bridge between two islands;

¹⁸ W—measured silicone circuits.

Like a focc¹⁹ and its gut;
With gullet-road to link them.

This neverending ludos,
Self-distinction seeking
Econic~~he~~construction:
Guard a goal with equal spacing,
Campo's zone o' coverage.

Or how a flower's yellow petals
Radiate a center,
Seeking yet-uncaptured sun, while
Tethered in Augustan walls. The
Bloodred poppy, rooted pared,
Young green in old stone while

—...Oo-Oooooo-Oooo—

Morning's "Dove?" coos in triple-time,
Playing hard to get, near cochineal,
Among the cactus fruits of feline colony.

Past limestone-Miocene—
The bossaged ashlar rows
And quoins, and azure waves.

Descent mimetic on misrecognition,
Like the bulls of Turin: honored
time-tradition
From the golden olden gules, we strolled—
She talked of liquifyping:
Talked of flowing finance, freezing over,
Talked expansion and contraction.
I was always looking down, wary of dogshit;
I was tired of looking down, and weary of
my wariness—

Drank sangre to revitalize, in wooden
chairs,
Feeling, on this day of days, like Eve by

Swinton.²⁰

Everywhere the talk of stock all falling
Everywhere the doves in mourning
No more children anyway, the talk of
Every birthrate falling.

—I must've been sundrunk & sleepdeprived,
—To buy that goddamn hat, trudging back
from ruins.

Soft light on the Reus creamstone,
Smell of oranges—
Cleaning fluid?
Gentle heel-tap on marble alley echo
Pinnate leaflets in a breezefall
Wheeled windy out to sea which separates
And bridges all.

The Middle Earth:
Self-mastery is master's master;
Alabaster stone in sea of gatorade,
In silver foil, plated Middle-earth,
The public square of Ancientswhorl.

49

I wanted an accounting
Of how strong ships wreck
On subtlehidden stones.

I wanted an accounting
Of how many great composers
Never found a venue,
Never found a patron,
Never found their players.

I was done with watercooler writing—
Seedy news—
The sidelines broadcast was OK, but

Shouldn't I be choosy with the games I
chose to cover?

Anyway,
The best were all tacticians
Little soap, & not a lot of sugar.
Surface near-implacable,
Unrackable & placid as the Catalan brulé
was eating in my decadence.

Stephen said, Look,
If you're not always trying & failing
To pay attention to near
Everything in life then
What are you doing?

Stephen said,
Too many big brave faces,
Scared of what might peck through pinhole
If they close their eyes.

And that the path was a mix of light and
shadow,
And if that made the path a metaphor,
fine.²¹ And that Beoffalo, the
abbey's dog, wrote poetry, in his
rosemary bush, and rode a bike to
town.

I'm getting a head of myself. Well then,
I get ahead of myself.

The spirits argued with each other,
Shamed and cheered me from my shoulders;
Civic dust had set.
Me & Newton & conchas.

A sky full of ghosts—
Light still traveled after the body was gone—
Or at least the body's form—

Since substance equaled pattern.²²

Was all this work not Christian, much like
Bryan Johnson?

Sacrifice the now to chance forever on a
dying sun?

A name in water never wrecks.

50

I fall. (How do you fall?) I remember.
I fly (How do you fly?) I remember.²³

Vermut:

A drowned & winged thing had slipped inside
my drink;

I lifted limp its body, which had sat all
soggy

Several minutes still & never stirring,
Til it resurrected woke,

& spread its wings
& sunward rose.

Ver'gutt, her glutes, in rise & fall, but
stop!

All these degrading games
Encasing me in flesh.

Tempt: To try, to test, to stretch

An arm, in feeling out for form.

Contempt: A way to ward temptation

Off, to hold beneath your station

Or invoke a norm, to punish deviation

That one's envious of.

A piston's pulse and rest is rhythm

²² "The holiness of saints survives the body [such that] it is an effective power for healing and blessing even after death..." (Deborah Tappehan, "Jonna and Tatoo," adapted.

²³ Chris Knox

²¹ G. Hoagland.

Breath and kick and rise again,
 As muscles clenched, relax,
 And who are we, to claim exemption?

51

Zaragoza! Where the streetlamps wear
 crowns!
 Zaragoza! Where sand runs red, and
 binders bind with calfskin.

Plenas pulsas planetarias; &
 We a pair o' peregrines, much aspirant
 To some transcendent pairing,
 Rising up with alas á la Lavoisier,
 Or Curies—They had chemistry!
 And me a Vakhemoninomad,
 Fast-talkin monad, 'static in a shorter
 Term alignment,
 Bab of his wisdom,
 The Spanish Miracle,
 Convivial product of convivencia under
 Blue-eyed Umappad.
 (Not like reconquistas,
 Crossing borders, birthing Catalan.)

Cæsaraugusta—so the Romans called it—
 Saragusta, spake the Moors.
 So al-Saragusti, student second-order
 Of the master al-Hariri journeyed
 From his homeland Westward
 Where the golden book were found.

52

"En 189 acuñaba Henri Gèraldi el término
 pirincismo. Bajo él se agrupaba a
 aquellos que tenían la resistencia

de ascender por las montañas, la
 facultad de percibir, y la habilidad
 para transmitirlo a los demás."
 (Wall text, Veruela Monastery,
 Zaragoza.)

Broad Balboa, top a peak in
 Panama, saw sea to shining sea, & Me?
 Grace to God for Southern Seas,
 Horizons which approached, recede, so
 Occident could still suffice
 For those who Orientalize
 As Barbarians saw the Visigoths
 And Moorish slavers praised blue eyes.

"Best thing to do is dig—
 One thing or place or man,"
 Til knowing more than any man about it
 So said Olson, on committing, not so much
 To form as to environ—
 He should know! Ningland poet;
 Jim chose foggy Dublin—
 Who am I above it, Johnson?

& Beatific doubling, "dig"—
 But I? In better moods dig everything,
 a problem—
 Better-known to Beats—
 Of too much sun & too much stim.

What's the answer, then, but study?
 Smarter, harder—¿Porque no los dos?—
 And better sure but slower, patient,
 Play along Pareto's front a frontier,
 Find the tax-free, rentiered double-dutied
 wins.

Well Pound & Olson, Drynne—
 Had things for stones now didn't they,
 Sculpture, rockecology, and chiseled
 gemstonepæms
 Or stacking layers, timely sediment, &

Wood turned mineral by pressure,
Polished sequence shining.
Not like jamband Kerouac, who tossed it
out
Diffuse and free.

Permanent poetics and its birdsong—
What is beautiful, ephemeral,
What lasts, a leaden echo?

"This is the morning, after the dispersion,
& the work of the morning is methodology:
how to use oneself & on what.
That is my profession.
I am an archæologist of morning."

More said Olson, cern'ing thru
accumulation,
Centuries of text—
He loved the taste of soil, so he said
And who are we to suspect?
Zeke was gave the infinite, &
A healthdaze craving bentonite.
Olson hunted hardened clay for scratching;
Stored his psychedelics in an owl idol
—fieldwork composing—
Chewed on alien maize, & gathered rosette
potsheerds.
Put together fragments watching indigenies'
sheepheerds.

Ô Mãe d'Água. If we are in the morning
of man,
Then that is a time for questions of
method.
Dawning, always dawning, downing, setting;
ev'ry
Veil just a vantage so select positions
wisely.
Rather than commit, exploiting
Onward go with our exploring:

Carnival to Lent to Easter,
feast of feasts in feastly cycle.
Cross the Roman Vest in armchair,
Wordsworth's Alps & Meister Darwin;
Banks' Tahiti, Byron's Childe;
Time Tombs of Hyperion.
Gæthe's Journey; Cook, von Humboldt;
Brönte, Stevenson, & Melville.
Or Carvajal, who blessed with final glance
At Amazon as civic wonder, squandered
handsome,
Caught up anxious in some future prison,
Couldn't soar with kapak orchestras,
Or justify his sight with reason.

There is no time, these days, they say,
To drink the blood of Christ
(There is no other time)
Nor take the waters
Cannot even taste our sweat.
To not be like that Carvajal—is any nobler
promise set?
(Or Corpsep. Kid is showing promise.)

And too reporting (after Johnson) with
An eye to study men & manners
Protocols for huéspedes, and hospice
philoxenia
As well as science, landscape, custom, way
of life—
In short, becoming those gold men of
letters, who
To Andalusian soil gathered knowledge in
their travels
Cross the cultures.

(Past-tense playing Perhaps, pleas to
coffee date:
five minutes can you spare me, girl; You'll
get Eternity.)

Kiss me darling, as I fly.

From Death to Resurrection lie:
 Ye, I had known the natural cycle
 Sunlit seasons, springtime tidal.
 Never, til now, in Catholic Europe
 Did I know their rite & symbol, &
 Swearing in a clearing, under God's first
 temple
 That I'd bridge the basalt with the birdsong
 nimble
 -& other oaths, which do not scan—
 Of permanent poetics: what can last &
 what is beautiful
 And what is ever slipping lost,
 Into unrecovered past.

For who else would report—it's not
 a matter of could—that chatty
 "cio", informal, lost its whiff of
 offense, being constantly invoked by
 tourists til the mothertongue was
 chastened?

And who else would report that CaliValley
 apps were sync'ing up the world,
 teaching protocols and virtues;
 graphics, language, system?

-If there are no walls, there are no
 names—
 We're still hung up on Charles, contra
 native Paz,
 Who saw in lined borders only stoppèd
 separation:
 Said, The mill? It squeeze juice from
 life;
 He could see the grain collecting—All his
 Cuartos, calles, ruas, rooms divided
 Man from man, & from himself, a violence
 Mourning "nuestra unidad"—an unidad
 perdida.

O homogenocene!
 Our Whitman's world, spanned
 Except as farce at first & second
 nightmare.

To navigate a gridded street,
 And choose between two turns like Frosted
 flakes.
 Do streets constrain us, or enable
 passage?
 One need only hack, like Carvajal,
 Through undergrowth to know the difference.
 And the merchants' code of choice?
 Now an ethic of consent, argued by
 dissenting voice.
 So all agreed—to's fine,
 & that which isn't, isn't.
 How simple is what simple does,
 Such beauty in its symmetry, &
 Power, then, is set aside;
 Its problem now is primary.

Wonder: Who has set the table?
 When & why assigned the labels?

53

But the Wind,
 Like light & fire
 Is wild & free,
 Connecting distant things—
 & I am that Wind,
 Here, on the metamorph, Montseny.
 Carrying signs & buoying wings.
 Here I pass an archivist, who prepped
 librettos for the best.
 Here is one who digs in weeds for herbal,
 ointment, spice & seed.
 Here a politician, like a hound-dog pulled to
 power;

Here a merry-faced mortician, manning
body's latest hour.

Here I pass a pilgrim who in past life was
a sybarite;

Now flagellant, he bears the lashes
Of the braided leather which I lilt & lift
like flag, to bare his back, thereby
to better know him.

Now I pass a stony cliff: A wave so
slowly crashing only God & I can
see it.

What sweet song will I bear to thee?
Or blessings billow, Buddha's sacred flags,
Or shepherds' dying whistles far across the
weighting canyon.

For the beauty of this place erases thought
of waiting for damnation.

Do I dare to speak, disturb a peach, or
preach an icon's quiet?

Do I dare say "Change your life" to
clients?

Will I keep an analytic blankness?
Let the torso's form & wife speak for my
better bitter message.

Or do I dare invoke the Cross, or share
cross-legged lotus lessons?

Words are only ever pointing; moonlit shine
the flames reflecting.

Youth like me know nearly nothing.

54

He on a piedra, she a pied-à-terre
In prairie still I heard a starling

Rattle, prattle to its darling,

Di & notte, so a

Sowing song that summoned mower,
Mourning dove at dawn on rooftop,
Roam & roving, raving mad at reaper's
progress,

Speed of strifeful strive & striding
Thru the tallgrass sashes, passes
Tearing, steering, ripping, stripping.

Seeds his medley mettletested, restless,
prescient;

Spat a stateley epithet & spake soas to
Sate the breast, & sans all rest, so
Dear to ear & deathless, sleepless,
Tire when & only pyre's fired, that his
Song the verdure quickened: Grass its
grassings;

Grazer, grazing; sped & fed the fiddlesickle,
Softly sighing.

Still it little mattered to some tattered
Scattered tones intoned against the stone
unheard,

No living stirred

Nor stared, nor started at his Art—
The starling prayed & swift departed in
A parabolic arc.

It was a post-scarcity behavioral response.
Chinese social media favored terms like
"involution."

-As Rosalind had told them once:

To change your fortune,

Change your fashion.

So the lashing [...]

-Told them they had lost their Passion.

Of Confidence Men in search of control,
Long put aside their Learning.

Servants of unexamined Forces, driven by
half-known Desires.

The hunting hawk was harnessed, for his
love of numbers.

The Northern bride made Heaven Hell, so
not to be encumbered.

... The plumber plumbed til he was empty;
all he found was escrementi.

Hypersex'd yet barren.

Moralizing, conscienceless.

Who worship the photogenic grid.

Who found in Furniture & a wellchosen
book cover a Perfect Life.

-Whoring satanstatusmarks. Wretched
lipservant.

-Then Hate the Game- (The Voice of
Reason)

-fine! A game of brutal useless byproduct.
Twisted metal.

(Gain a grain 'o generous gentle.)

Little Lamb. The problem is so rarely
that we do not know-but that we
do not let it ripple cross our being

& behavior.

Shy we are & look away-in fear, inertia,
frictionless our false God, treat
our ignorance as savior.

for I would look through lists
of tinted lenses,

fore I'd soothe one real.

> be me
 > be backpack lad
 > always carry on, never check
 > gate lady says i have to check it anyway.
 > annoyed but whatever.jpeg
 > go through security. no one asks for id.
 > security theater.exe
 > get to gate. wait around. acquire meds.
 > mfw mēm flurry.
 > maybe flying not so bad.
 > my group is called. go up to show ticket.
 > same lady.
 > "passport please"
 > look for passport.
 > oshit ofuckfuckfuck
 > passport is in checked bag.
 > give her license instead.
 > "no anon, must be passport."
 > tell her what happened.
 > sorry anon you cant board.
 > i see my bag outside sitting on tarmac
 waiting to be loaded.
 > point.
 > doesn't matter
 > vestguy says he can get it off tarmac,
 no problem
 > gate lady says no, anon will have to
 learn his lesson.
 > > learn his lesson
 > says to catch the next flight in a couple
 hours.
 > sends me back through security.
 > get in queue to speak to airline
 > "sorry anon no flights til tomorrow."
 > "also you will have to pay full ticket
 price."
 > silent seething.
 > sleep on airport floor. eat stale honeybun
 from vending.
 > start reading unabomber wiki

> maybe he has a point.

56

And there are no faces anymore, the World
is faceless.

Instead we are a system of other signs,
Which speak to our position, assets,
raising—

All but emotion—

And are become in turn our masks,
And not the feeling under them.

What cruel karma now, enacting
crudekliche of city cynic,
Manure in me boot-treads for going back
to "Country,"

Raymond Williams face; say "I am
disappoint."

Avillage pokel, puh, for thinking city folk'll
like ye.

Oh but how gay & light is Frankie!
Polymorphously perverse. He lurved the city.
He loaved the city. He luffed it. He had
lovers all over it.

When did I love the city? When I was
in love, I guess.

Or when I dreamed of what it worked,
when work that way did not.

Our cabbie spoke six words of English, one
of them when we told her where
we'd come from:

-Gepoooteefull! she cried; not words I'd
usually use

To describe the Concrete Wilds.

Maybe I'll write to Gershwin's reed, I

said;
Sensitivity was the heart of it.
What I'd lost and what I needed.

The piazza was packed with
twenty-somethings.

I sung,
-We all know you're hard cuz we've all
seen your leather.
-We all know you're soft cuz we've all
seen your sweatpants.

Fascist inbreath.
Acquiescent out while
Polystyrene
Poly sirens
Poly their styles,
Renegotiate their terms
Of social presence with a crimson smile.

The girls are Old Masters of blush &
blush. Dark foundations through
lightdusted overcoat. Now the
perfume bottles. Whole carriage
smell of bouquet. I felt
myself traversing the curve of a
Verkes-Dodson while she spoke.

Ben-It's said in every world walks the
perfect being once... Roman
candles are his hautboys. But does
he, or is this a wished simplicity?
Do we still believe that Beauty
stands sure proxy, costly signal of
our Quality? Or is much beauty
treacherous, a lure from deepsea
deadly fish?

We brought him cheese, &
Pink-lady apples;
He traded purple garden artichokes
for red transulence gooseberries,
And spoke on the beauty of van Morrison,
Donne, and Dylan's Backpages.
We brought the dog treats;
And I learned the meaning of hospitality,
The olive sprites bowed in breezy grace.
But he'd never heard "Summertime in
England",
And found Malick hopeless slow.

He led a meditation with Sanskrit cant;
Learned from his father before him,
Who'd learned it from India,
An Eastern infusion, for a church in much
need of it.

I asked him how he chose the block to
carve,
And each of a million chisels,
And the shape they summed to.

And I asked the tower how it chose a hill
to tower from.
And I asked the valley plot of land its
plan and if it liked its veil.

And I asked the vine the trellis,
How it pathed up red, How short its sight,
How great its power where it long had
learned to flourish,
In the search for light-

Except, sometimes, in stranger soils,
And quick-shift environs.
Then it climbs toward rays which will not
feed it;
Then it feels, seeking, for what
form it will not find there.

Clouds cling on to Capri like fabrics on a
thieving thorn.

Cinema's cuisine: Comer com olhos;
skirtswish

(It pulls our bonds apart, the boundless)

Seaside girls—

If sharps are winning wisdom's choosing
games

A field of play: Pablo Falcón King of
Trash.

Broombuds to the cliff-face cling
Enchanting clerestory bees.

The hotel (Lorelai its name)

For all its modern glass, for

All its blacksquared steel still exposed

The brick of past foundations framed in
careful-chosen stations:

Lowlylit like candlelight;

Less for pleasure of the eye than

Guests's imagination.

Here along Sorrento's coast

Elites are being socialized—

They socialize each other—

Over drinks and photogenic views;

With men who made money in online
casinos;

With gulls that lurk & steal chips

While workers of the world work

To system dreams of tiny teams

From coasts of California.

—Steve's garage around her mother's
corner.—

And even Spanish mother-daughter

Speak in angled tongue to order,

Using words of protest from

A people known for having points.²⁴

Italy for a walkabout.

Tourism was the new pilgrimage.

It was a practice of contemplation and
prayer.

You could draw the mountaineering
throughline from the Romantics.

These days, climbers were less interested
in the theoretical victory of the
summit.

So much stayed the same while changing
names.

He wanted to know the difference between
hermit & homeless;

Escape and exile, she answered. How
you spend your hours, that's what
counts:

Self not in noun, but verb.

We were in search of a heavenly home,

Somewhere under God's rays

Enough rain but not too much

We wanted to do something simple,

Land to ramble

Space to sing unheard except by bird,

To live in stone & sun & vegetal;— &

Leisure work & play all one,

Or least their alternation.

—What cannot be accomplished in
simultan'ity

—Is easily accomplished with Temporality.

(A lesson from the prairie's pacts)

²⁴ & Anteros, risking Pointless forest.

Takeaway sammies; turkey for eaters of
flesh.

Travel as timetravel, a trip to the country.
Ask em to perform the old ways, throw em
a buck.

Wash our feet in cool stream.

In Napoli
We gazed upon the sea
Its isles of time
Its oceans of perspective,
And the cliffs sang hymn to the setting
sun.

Was there incident inciting?
The distant cry of gulls, on Western
shore, or
Eve's forbidden fruit. A point at which you
cannot go on being a part of it
all,
Society I mean.

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And the Park is full of Children's Play
White ankles glint in Plaited Stream
Their screams are heard from ridge of
distant bridge.

So many Children in the World still!
So many Kids left in the World.

It was uncultured, to have children.
It showed a lack of loyalty to one's city.
It was an insult to gay lifestyles. I was
1st among my friends at 30;

We knew a few acquaintances. One pair
we liked especially in Boston.

Met the little one.

Godson to another.

And there were faces yes, there were
faces!

There are you, Child! Little Lamb.
-Was't thou shy once? asks the Child.
-Just so small as me?

I Too Have Longed for Foreign fields
Where none can read my soulprintheel.

Or lazy daze'o'days on summer lawns all
summer long,
and sans ambition.

—One need not always stand ready—
—Able to explain oneself—
—Tho one may want to—

Take this from one who desperate wants to
be a goodman
That it's in my interest to become one—
or to Seem one, to Myself, eternal
question, set it aside;
Still the search to mitigate
A second order

—One need not always plague oneself with
premonitions—
—Save the energy expended, visioned future—
—Flames on goal & chalice—glow

Live without regret and guilt
And try to follow lark and not to flee from
Love and leave by golden carrot,
Not to learn by errors but
To double-down on deeds then.

—One need not seek for fountain flowing
filling by itself in endless motion—
—It will never be enough—
—It will never last forever.

Thus ends this alba

Wherever you are I hope
you're right in front
with it: I mean,
from this you
really ought to
feel loaned a
really haughty
stare for any
thing around you
boring or obnoxious; because the force of
my demand that you be free of
such is inalienably magical.

LOVE

Jeremy